

Topic 8.1

8.1: Comments on Reading Assignments for Module 7

Error handling is difficult in any language. There are two aspects to it, both of which are hard. First, we have to get from the place where an error occurred to a place where we can handle the error. Second, we have to figure out how to fix things, then "get back" to where we were when the error occurred. This module deals almost exclusively with the first aspect, as the second aspect is highly situation-dependent (What errors are possible? How important is it for the program to proceed at all costs? etc.).

There is a language-independent solution for the first aspect, as illustrated in these notes. It is not very nice to use, as the mainstream code is intermixed with all the error handling stuff. Nevertheless, it is a pervasive solution in many languages. In my notes I present the C solution to this issue as a precursor for understanding C++ exceptions.

The textbook is a bit terse on this subject; Eckel's *Thinking in C++* is much more comprehensive.

Topic 8.2 (<https://onlinelearning.berkeley.edu/courses/2291660/pages/topic-8-dot-2>)